

Cyber Threat Intelligence (CTI) Strategy Report

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1. Objectives and Scope Definition

- **Define Objectives:** * Contain ransomware  before lateral movement occurs.
 - Secure Electronic Medical Records (EMRs) to uphold **HIPAA** compliance.
 - Ensure operational continuity of telehealth services during incidents.
- **Define Scope:** This strategy covers EMR software, telehealth platforms, and endpoint security across the organization. Key departments include IT Security, Compliance, and Incident Response (IR).
- **Policy Alignment:** The primary driver is **HIPAA** and healthcare data privacy laws. This strategy prioritizes integrity of patient records and availability of care systems.

2. Threat Intelligence Needs Assessment

- **Risk Assessment:**
 - **Ransomware:** Critical risk to patient care systems (High Impact/Likelihood).
 - **Credential Theft:** Unauthorized access leading to breaches.
 - **Third-Party Risk:** Vulnerabilities introduced by vendor access.
- **Stakeholder Collaboration:** * **IT Security:** Needs **IOCs** (Indicators of Compromise) for EDR tuning.
 - **Compliance:** Needs audit-ready intelligence for regulatory alignment.
 - **IR Team:** Needs **Tactical Intelligence** on ransomware behavior for faster containment.
- **Prioritization:** Intelligence efforts are focused on ransomware TTPs (Tactics, Techniques, and Procedures) due to the immediate threat to patient safety .

3. Gathering and Integrating Intelligence Sources

- **Intelligence Sources:**
 - **Internal:** CrowdStrike EDR logs, Veeam backup alerts, and EMR access logs.
 - **External:** **Recorded Future** feeds, healthcare-specific threat data, and OSINT.
- **Integration Process:** Threat feeds from Recorded Future are integrated directly into **CrowdStrike** to automate the blocking of known malicious hashes and IPs.
- **Source Validation:** Sources are validated by cross-referencing Recorded Future's high-fidelity alerts with internal telemetry from CrowdStrike to confirm relevance to the SecureHealth environment.

4. Development of Threat Intelligence Processes

- **Data Collection Procedures:** We gather raw threat data from **Recorded Future** and internal telemetry from **CrowdStrike**. We specifically hunt for **IOCs** such as ransomware file extensions, known malicious IP addresses, and suspicious PowerShell commands used in credential theft.
- **Analysis and Insight Generation:** Our analysis focuses on mapping observed behaviors to the **MITRE ATT&CK** framework. By identifying attack tactics (e.g., lateral movement or data exfiltration), we generate insights that help the IT team proactively harden the network.
- **Dissemination Protocols:** Urgent alerts are pushed to the **Incident Response (IR)** and **IT Security** teams via real-time communication channels. Detailed intelligence reports are stored for the **Compliance** team to verify that we are meeting **HIPAA** reporting requirements.

5. CTI Capability and Infrastructure Building

- **Tool and Platform Acquisition:** * **TIP:** Recorded Future for external intelligence integration.
 - **EDR:** CrowdStrike for endpoint visibility and automated containment.
 - **Backup/Recovery:** Veeam to ensure data availability after an attack.
 - **Team Development and Training:** We are prioritizing training for the **IR Team** on "Intelligence-Led Response." This involves using threat data to anticipate the next move of a ransomware actor rather than just reacting to alerts.
 - **Capability Evaluation:** Currently, SecureHealth has excellent tooling but needs to better integrate **Veeam** alerts into the CTI workflow to detect "backup-deletion" tactics used by modern ransomware.
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6. Communication and Collaboration Channels

- **Internal Communication Channels:** * **Technical:** Direct integration between Recorded Future and CrowdStrike for automated blocking.
 - **Strategic:** Weekly briefings with the **Compliance Team** to review threat trends against **HIPAA** security rules.
- **External Collaboration:** We share anonymized threat data with healthcare-specific sharing communities to stay ahead of regional ransomware campaigns.
- **Collaboration Challenges:** The primary challenge is ensuring technical jargon is translated into actionable risk information for non-technical stakeholders.

7. CTI Effectiveness Measurement and Optimization

- **Key Performance Indicators (KPIs):**

- **Dwell Time:** Reducing the time a threat exists in the network before being neutralized by CrowdStrike.
 - **Recovery Time Objective (RTO):** The speed at which Veeam can restore EMR systems after a simulated or real attack.
 - **Compliance Score:** Maintaining 100% adherence to regulatory logging and reporting standards.
- **Continuous Improvement Process:** We conduct "Post-Incident Reviews" after every high-priority alert to refine our intelligence feeds and EDR configurations.
- **Stakeholder Feedback:** Monthly meetings with the **IT Security** and **Compliance** teams ensure the intelligence we provide remains relevant to their specific operational needs.